



THE GOLD STANDARD · BY HANNAH GOLDY

WARM-UP & COOL-DOWN SYSTEM

Do these every session

THE 4-STEP WARM-UP [5-7 MINUTES]

- 1 Step 1 — Increase Heart Rate**
5–10 minutes of light cardio to increase circulation and body temperature: jump rope, light jogging, row machine, stationary bike, or incline walking.
- 2 Step 2 — Dynamic Mobility**
Hip circles — 10 each direction · Arm circles — 10 forward and backward · Bodyweight squats — 10 · Walking lunges — 10 each leg · Torso rotations — 10 each side.
- 3 Step 3 — Muscle Activation**
Glute bridges — 10–12 · Band pull-aparts — 12–15 · Plank — 30 seconds · Light pushups — 8–10.
- 4 Step 4 — Warm-Up Sets**
Before your first heavy exercise, perform 1–2 lighter sets of that exact movement. Gradually increase weight until you reach your working sets.

THE COOL-DOWN & RECOVERY SYSTEM [5-10 MINUTES]

- 1 Step 1 — Gradually Lower Your Heart Rate**
A few minutes of light activity: slow walking, light cycling, or gentle rowing.
- 2 Step 2 — Stretch Major Muscle Groups**
Hold each 30 seconds, stretch slowly, no bouncing: hamstring stretch · quad stretch (each leg) · hip flexor stretch (each side) · chest stretch · shoulder stretch.
- 3 Step 3 — Deep Breathing (Box Breathing, 4-4-4)**
Inhale through your nose 4 seconds · hold 4 seconds · exhale through your mouth 4 seconds. Repeat 4–5 breaths.
- 4 Step 4 — Hydration and Nutrition**
Drink water or electrolytes. Protein for muscle repair, carbohydrates to replenish energy. A balanced meal or snack within a few hours of training.
- 5 Step 5 — Prioritize Sleep**
Aim for 7–9 hours of quality sleep each night. During sleep the body repairs muscle tissue, restores energy, and regulates hormones.